

## Myths and Realities of Coronary Heart Disease (CHD)

Coronary Heart Disease (CHD):- Is the commonest variety of heart Disease. It occurs as a result of critical blockages in coronary arteries (arteries supplying blood to the heart), compromising blood supply to the heart muscle and manifesting as angina pectoris, acute myocardial infarction (heart attack), or sudden death.

### FAQ

Question:Coronary Heart Disease (CHD): Is it curable?

Answer:No, it is not curable. The disease course can be modified by proper medical therapy and intervention at appropriate time.

Question:Medication of proven CHD: Is it life long?

Answer:Yes, it is life long. depending upon parameters and symptoms the drugs and doses are modified.

Question:What are the risk factors?

Answer:Age, male gender, family history of premature CHD, high blood pressure, Diabetes Mellitus, smoking, tobacco chewing, high blood cholesterol, obesity, sedentary life style and psychosocial factors.

Question:Can CHD be controlled by modifying risk factors?

Answer:Yes, it may reduce the risk or slow down the progression of CHD.

Question:Can I develop CHD without risk factors?

Answer:Yes, one can develop CHD but risk of premature CHD is slim provided lifestyle is healthy.

Question:Bypass surgery (CABG): Is it a cure for CHD?

Answer:No, it is only palliation. There is about 1-2% mortality and about 2-3% morbidity in bypass surgery. The recovery is about 2-3 months. About 2/3 of patients usually come back by 10 years with some or other problem.

Question:Angioplasty (stenting): is it a cure for CHD?

Answer:No, it is again palliation. It is a low risk procedure in majority of patients. Done as a percutaneous procedure (as angiography) without any incision or General Anesthesia (GA). With the newer Drug Eluting Stents, the success is nearly 100% and recovery is quick (within 07 days). The blockages may recur within 6-8 months if at all (in < 10% of patients). After that period, the further chances of recurrence are less.

Question:Medication for high cholesterol: Is it life long?

Answer:Yes, in majority of patients. But, the doses can be adjusted depending upon the levels and side effects.

Question:Can I develop CHD without high cholesterol levels?

Answer:Yes, you can develop CHD without high cholesterol levels because cholesterol is not the only risk factor.

Question:Is yoga a substitute for physical exercise for prevention of CHD?

Answer:No, it is complementary to exercise.



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